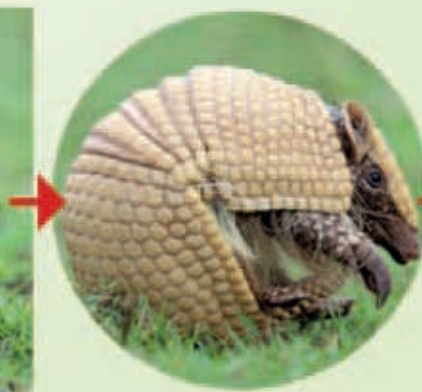




Three-banded armadillo stops still if threatened



Head and legs tuck in



Body rolls up



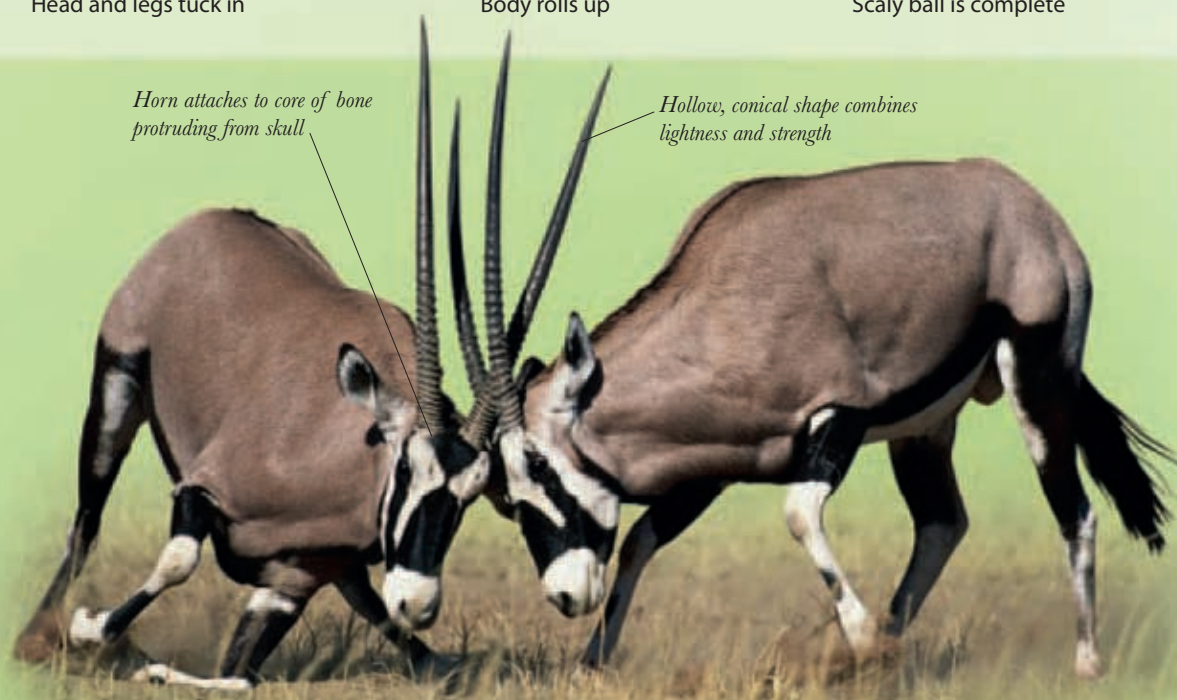
Scaly ball is complete



Pectoral fin

Boxed in

Boxfish are well-protected by tough scales, which are reinforced with flat, bony plates. These armored scales lock together to form a rigid case, with holes for the fish's fins. A boxfish cannot curve its body and is a poor swimmer. It propels itself along by fluttering the pectoral fins on each side of its body like high-speed oars.

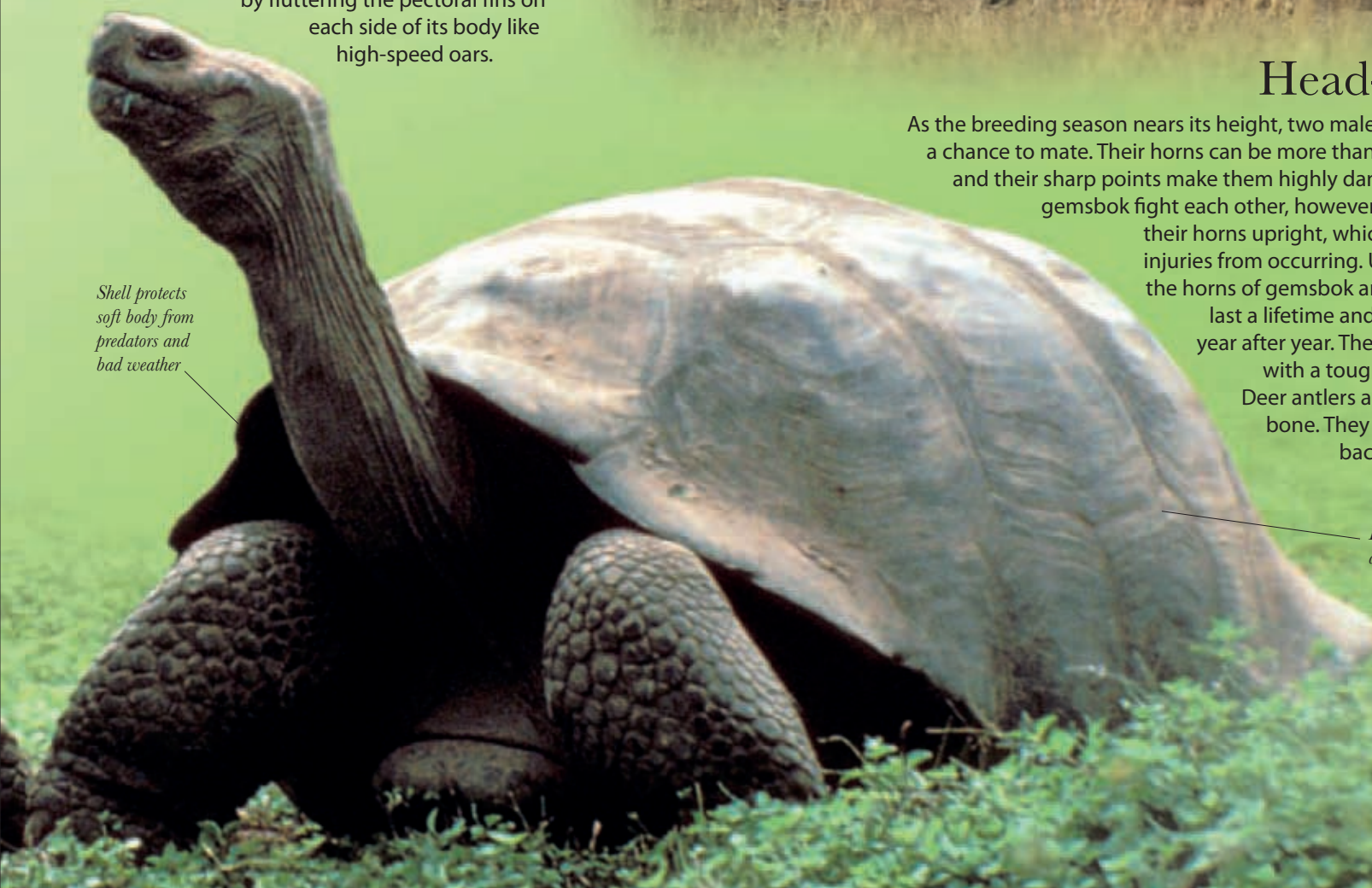


Horn attaches to core of bone protruding from skull

Hollow, conical shape combines lightness and strength

Head-on clash

As the breeding season nears its height, two male gemsbok fight for a chance to mate. Their horns can be more than 30 in (80 cm) long and their sharp points make them highly dangerous. Whenever gemsbok fight each other, however, they usually keep their horns upright, which prevents serious injuries from occurring. Unlike deer antlers, the horns of gemsbok and other antelopes last a lifetime and continue growing year after year. They have a bony core with a tough protein covering. Deer antlers are made entirely of bone. They are shed and grow back larger every year.



Shell protects soft body from predators and bad weather

Large scales, called scutes, cover shell's bony plates